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Senior Software Engineer

Department for Work and Pensions

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 20th September 2026



Department
for Work &
Pensions

Reference number

466901

Salary

£57,946 - £80,664

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

DWP - Digital

Type of role

Digital
Engineering
Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

10

Contents

Location

About the job

Benefits

Things you need to know

Apply and further information

Location

This role will be based in Leeds.

Please find further information on the [Corporate hub locations here](#).

About the job

Job summary

Please note this role requires you to pass [Security Check](#) clearance. For further information, please see 'Selection process details'.

Are you a Senior Software Engineer looking to utilise cutting edge technologies to develop and deliver products?

Do you want to use your skills and experience to help deliver high value applications and processes to a wide variety of stakeholders, supporting DWP's digital transformation?

If so, this is a fantastic opportunity to join an exciting, high profile team delivering real business value and improving the experience and outcomes for our many customers!

Within Working Age Services Digital, we are responsible for several existing services which support the core of society and is the department's highest profile benefit service, Universal Credit.

Let's be clear about the impact of your work – the products we build are the changing the face of public services with the potential to dramatically transform the future of millions of people.

We are looking for the kind of person who enjoys a challenge. Working Age Services is undergoing a period of technical change in line with our technical strategy – aiming to become more consistent in our ways of working, more

standardised in our technical stacks, and transforming some of our services and monolithic architectures into microservices.

Job description

Our Senior Software Engineers lead and set the strategy as well as build our products and applications with researchers, testers, architects, analysts and designers as part of multifunctional agile delivery teams.

What really excites us is problem-solving. We have a unique opportunity to deliver innovative technology that carries real value for millions of users.

Our teams benefit from working together, actively seek input from colleagues, and prioritise ideas from across disciplines, grades, and job titles rather than hierarchy.

As a Senior Software Engineers, you will:

- Be part of a supportive Engineering community of practice, with hundreds of engineering experts from across the UK united by passion and purpose. We'll give you the tools and time to build your capability, with coaching, mentoring, qualifications and formal learning, meet-ups or whatever else works for you.

- Be a leader in our team; you will coach and mentor our already skilled and creative Engineering team.

- Share a brilliant environment with colleagues from across DWP and wider government, making it the perfect place to collaborate and build networks.

- Promote software engineering practices and establishing collaborative team cultures that produce world class software solutions.

- Use your skills in software design principles, patterns, and paradigms to produce software products used by millions of people.

- Focusing on operational stability, robustness, resilience, availability, and quality you will be accountable for the code you and your teams produce.

- Promote and support the following of best practice and guide our teams on how to deliver quality software products.

- Help design and support the strategies for building reusable libraries and services.

Support Software Engineering teams providing technical leadership and guidance.

Person specification

See selection process for further details.

If you would like to learn more about the role, please contact
Natalie.selby1@dwp.gov.uk

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Leadership

Seeing the Big Picture

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Programming and Build

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £57,946, Department for Work and Pensions contributes £16,786 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\).](#)

We also have a broad benefits package built around your work-life balance which includes:

Working patterns to support work/life balance such as job sharing, term-time working, flexi-time and compressed hours.

Generous annual leave at least 25 days on entry, increasing up to 30 days over time (pro rata for part time employees), plus 9 days public and privilege leave.

Support for financial wellbeing, including interest-free season ticket loans for travel, a cycle to work scheme and an employee discount scheme.

Health and wellbeing support including our Employee Assistance Programme for specialist advice and counselling and the opportunity to join HASSRA a first-class programme of competitions, activities and benefits for its members (subscription payable monthly).

Family friendly policies including enhanced maternity and shared parental leave pay after 1 year's continuous service.

Funded learning and development to support progress in your role and career. This includes industry recognised qualifications and accreditations, coaching, mentoring and talent development programmes.

An inclusive and diverse environment with opportunities to join professional and interpersonal networks including Women's Network, National Race Network, National Disability Network (THRIVE) and many more.

Hybrid Working

This role may be suitable for hybrid working, which is where an employee works part of the week in their DWP office and part of the week from home. This is a voluntary, non-contractual arrangement and your office will be your contractual place of work.

If a hybrid working arrangement is suitable for the role and for you, you will normally be required to spend a minimum of 60% of your contracted working hours from your DWP office.

If you have a disability, caring responsibilities, or other circumstances that may affect your ability to meet the minimum office attendance requirement, please discuss this with us using the contact details in this advert.

Salary Information

Pay for this role is from £57,946 to £80,664.

The maximum salary for the grade is £68,205, however a Digital Allowance of up to £12,459 per annum is available for exceptional candidates. Digital Allowance is non-salary, and non-pensionable, and is classed as a temporary allowance. It is reviewed annually where it could be retained, amended, or removed.

Our offer to successful candidates will be based on an assessment of your skills and experience as demonstrated at interview.

Existing Civil Servants who secure a new role on lateral transfer will maintain their current substantive salary.

Existing Civil Servants who gain promotion will move to the bottom of the grade pay scale or receive a 10% increase applied to their current substantive salary, whichever is greater.

Any temporary allowances that you are currently in receipt of will not form part of the calculation to determine your pay. Any allowances that are in payment will cease when you move into your new role.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

Stage 1: Application

Your application will consist of four parts:

1. A Personal Details application form.
2. Employment history - this should contain your work experience and any skills, qualifications and accomplishments relevant to the jobs you have completed.
3. Personal statement - up to 1000 words. This statement should be used to provide examples of how you meet the essential criteria below:

Significant experience of building in cloud-based environments like AWS and Azure.

An Excellent understanding of TDD and BDD.

Detailed working knowledge of SQL and noSQL database applications such as Postgres, MySQL, and MongoDB.

Extensive experience and proven track record in the build up a useful, robust automated test suite to support a continuous deployment environment.

Strong working knowledge and practical experience of APIs, RESTful services and Microservice Architectures.

4. Technical statement (up to 250 words). The following statement is aligned to the required technical skill of Programming and Build. This statement should be used to provide one or more examples of how you meet the criterion below:

A proven track record of building and deploying modern Java applications.

Ensure that all examples provided in your statements are taken directly from your own experience and that you describe the examples in your own words. If you choose to use gen-AI to support your statements, you must follow the guidelines outlined in the **Artificial intelligence and recruitment guide**.

The sift panel will use the information in your employment history, personal statement, and technical statement to assess your experience, skills and knowledge.

An initial sift will be conducted using the technical statement. Candidates who pass the initial sift will be progressed to a full sift.

If you do progress to a full sift, you will be provided with one combined overall assessment score for both your employment history and Personal Statement.

For Hints and Tips on completing your application visit [Applying for jobs at DWP Digital](#).

Important Information

You will be asked to complete your employment history. Any information that you would customarily share on a CV should therefore be entered onto the application form.

Personal details that could be used to identify you including your name, contact details and address must be removed for your application to be considered.

If your employment history, personal statement or technical statement contain any personal details your application will be withdrawn.

Stage 2: Coding Test

If you are successful at the sift stage, we will send you a coding test to complete remotely.

Please add Digital.EngineeringRecruitment@dwp.gov.uk to your safe senders list or monitor your spam folder to make sure you can receive the coding test email.

The test will focus on the technical elements listed in the essential criteria in this advert. You must not use any AI or generative tools when completing the test.

You will have **7 days** to complete the test from the date we send it.

If you pass the coding test, we will invite you to the face-to-face assessment centre.

Stage 3: Face-to-Face Assessment Centre

If you are successful in the coding test, you will be invited to attend a face-to-face assessment centre at our Leeds Digital Hub (Quarry House).

Assessment centres will take place between 02/11/26 to 6/11/26. **You will be required to attend on only one of these dates. These dates are fixed and cannot be altered. No alternative dates will be provided. The assessment centre will last approximately 3 to 4 hours and will feature three main components:**

Coding Pairing Exercise - this will assess your performance against the essential criteria listed for the role.

Group Exercise - this activity is designed to evaluate the two Behaviours outlined in the advert above.

Interview - the interview will test you against the essential criteria.

We will send you further details if you pass the sift and coding test.

Recruitment Timeline

The recruitment process will adhere strictly to the following schedule. Please ensure you are available for all stages before applying. **These dates are fixed and cannot be altered. No alternative dates will be provided.**

The advert will close on Sunday 20/09/26 at 11:55pm.

We will send the coding test on 05/10/26.

The coding test submission deadline is 11/10/26 at 11:55pm.

The Leeds Assessment Centre will be 02/11/26 to 6/11/26.

We will contact you to tell you whether you have been successful or not from mid November 2026 .

Near Miss Criteria

Following the assessment centre stage, if you do not reach the required standard for the advertised Grade 7 role, we may be able to offer you a role which would be a grade below the advertised post under our Near Miss process. If you fall into this category, we will contact you once the interview results have been released.

Security Clearance Requirement

You must meet the security requirements before you can be appointed. The level of security needed is security check.

You must have resided continuously in the UK for at least 3 of the last 5 years, 2 of which must have been the immediately preceding years from the point of applying for this job.

For further information on National Security Vetting please [visit the Demystifying Vetting website](#).

Further Information:

At the Department for Work and Pensions (DWP) we value diversity and inclusion and actively encourage and welcome applications from everyone, including those that are underrepresented in our workforce.

Find out more about working for DWP on the [DWP Careers Hub](#).

For Hints and Tips on completing your application visit [Applying for jobs at DWP Digital](#).

If high application volumes are received, the benchmark for candidates to proceed to the next stage may be raised. In line with our commitment to the Disability Confident Scheme (DCS), we aim to advance all candidates applying under the DCS who meet the minimum standard. However, we may only progress those candidates who best meet the required standards.

Reserve List

A reserve list may be held for a period of 6 months from which further appointments can be made.

If you are placed on a reserve list but we cannot immediately offer you a post, please note:

If you are later offered the role you applied for, in a location you have expressed a preference for, and you decline the offer or are unable to take up the post within a reasonable timeframe you will be withdrawn from the campaign and removed from the reserve list, other than in exceptional circumstances (e.g. a contractual Part Time Working Pattern cannot be accommodated in the initial role offered or in cases of serious ill health).

If DWP makes an offer of an alternative role or location to that which you originally applied for, and you decline that offer, you will be able to remain on the reserve list.

Disability Confident Scheme

If high application volumes are received, the benchmark for candidates to proceed to the next stage may be raised. In line with our commitment to the Disability Confident Scheme (DCS), we aim to advance all candidates applying under the DCS who meet the minimum standard. However, we may only progress those candidates who best meet the required standards.

Reasonable Adjustments

We consider visible and non-visible disabilities, neurodiversity or learning differences, chronic medical conditions, or mental ill health. Examples include dyslexia, epilepsy, autism, chronic fatigue, or schizophrenia.

If you need a change to be made so that you can make your application, you should contact the Government Recruitment Service via DWPRecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk as soon as possible before the closing date to discuss your needs.

Complete the Reasonable Adjustments section in the Additional requirements page of your application form to tell us what changes or help you might need further on in the recruitment process. For instance, you may need wheelchair access at interview, or if you're deaf, a Language Service Professional.

If you are experiencing accessibility problems with any attachments on this advert, please contact the email address in the 'Contact point for applicants' section.

Integrity, plagiarism and Civil Service Principles

The Civil Service values honesty and integrity and expects all candidates to abide by these principles.

Please ensure that all examples provided in your application are taken directly from your own experience and that you describe the examples in your own words.

Examples of plagiarism can include:

- Presenting the work, ideas and experience of others as your own
- Copying content or answers from an online or published source that is not your own

Disclosure and Barring Service and Internal Fraud Database Checks

To process applications without delay, we will be sending a Criminal Record Check to Disclosure and Barring Service on your behalf. However, we recognise in exceptional circumstances some candidates will want to send their completed forms direct. If you will be doing this, please advise Government Recruitment Service of your intention by emailing Pre-EmploymentChecks.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk stating the job reference number in the subject heading.

Applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued. Any applicant's details held on the IFD will be refused employment. A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5 year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

If successful and transferring from another Government Department, a criminal record check will be carried out.

Important

New entrants are expected to join on the minimum of the pay band.

Before applying for this vacancy, current employees of DWP should check whether a successful application would result in changes to their terms & conditions of employment, e.g. mobility, pay, allowances. If you are a current employee and are successful you must be able to be released from your current post within four weeks.

Those on protected TUPE/ COSoP terms and conditions applying on promotion or voluntary permanent level move will adopt DWP's Terms and Conditions and this may have a different impact on pay and allowances. Please review this prior to acceptance of a role.

Civil Servants that would transfer into DWP from other government organisations, following successful application, will assume DWP's terms & conditions of employment current on the day they are posted, unless DWP has stated otherwise in writing. Accepting a post will be taken to mean acceptance of revised terms & conditions.

Civil Servants applying on promotion will usually be appointed to the salary minimum or within 10% of existing salary.

Any move to DWP from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may, however, be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at the [Childcare Choices Website](#).

For further information on reasonable adjustments, terms and conditions and how we recruit visit the [How we recruit page](#).

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Natalie Selby

Email : Natalie.selby1@dwp.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : digitalrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with these principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should in the first instance contact DWP by email: HR.BUSINESSASSURANCE@DWP.GOV.UK.

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the Department, you can contact the Civil Service Commission. Click [here](#) to visit the Civil Service Commission.

